

4.3 The way in which the selection of thermoforming and thermosetting polymers is influenced	The influence of the following factors when selecting materials for a specific application.
	4.3.1 Aesthetic factors: a form b colour c texture.
	4.3.2 Environmental factors: a sustainability b pollution c biodegradable polymers – Biopol®
	4.3.3 Availability factors: a use of stock materials b use of specialist materials c effect of global oil supply.
	4.3.4 Cost factors: a quality of material b manufacturing processes necessary c treatments: fire proofing, additives d commodity price – world oil price.
	4.3.5 Social factors: a use for different social groups b trends/fashion c popularity.

POLYMERS

Key idea	What students need to learn:
	4.3.6 Cultural and ethical factors: - a avoiding offence - b suitability for intended market - c use of colour and language - d the consumer society - e the effects of mass production - f built-in product obsolescence.